# 05_IT_Runbooks_and_Support

Meridian Global Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

**Document classification:** Internal — IT Access Only **Applies to:** IT Support Team, System Administrators **Last reviewed:** January 2026 | **Owner:** IT Infrastructure Team

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## 1. Purpose and Scope

This document provides standard operating procedures and runbooks for the IT Support team to handle common incidents, requests, and maintenance tasks consistently across the organization.

## 2. Incident Severity Levels

| Severity | Definition | Response Time | Resolution Target |
|---|---|---|---|
| SEV-1 (Critical) | Company-wide outage, production down | 15 minutes | 4 hours |
| SEV-2 (High) | Major feature/system impaired, multiple users affected | 30 minutes | 8 hours |
| SEV-3 (Medium) | Single user or non-critical system affected | 4 hours | 2 business days |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| SEV-4 (Low) | Minor issue, cosmetic, or general request | 1 business day | 5 business days |

## 3. Standard Operating Procedure — Password Reset

1. Verify requester identity via employee ID and registered email/phone (voice verification for phone requests).
2. Initiate reset through the Identity Management console.
3. Enforce password complexity requirements (minimum 12 characters, mixed case, number, symbol).
4. Send reset link to the employee’s registered email only — never share temporary passwords via chat or phone.
5. Log the reset in the ticketing system with timestamp and verification method used.

## 4. Standard Operating Procedure — VPN Setup

1. Confirm employee’s role and remote access approval in the Identity Management system.
2. Provision VPN client license and generate a unique certificate for the device.
3. Guide employee through client installation using the standard onboarding guide (KB-IT-0032).
4. Test connectivity to at least two internal resources before closing the ticket.
5. VPN access is auto-revoked upon employee exit as part of the offboarding workflow (Section 9).

## 5. Standard Operating Procedure — Laptop Provisioning

1. Confirm asset request approval from the New Hire Onboarding workflow.
2. Image laptop with the standard corporate build (OS version, endpoint security agent, MDM enrollment).
3. Pre-install approved software bundle based on department (see Software Catalog, KB-IT-0045).
4. Register asset tag in the Asset Management system, linked to employee ID.
5. Hand over with signed Asset Acceptance form (digital, via IT portal).

## 6. Standard Operating Procedure — Server Restart

1. Confirm restart is not scheduled during a business-critical window (check Change Calendar).
2. Notify affected team via the #it-maintenance channel at least 30 minutes in advance for non-emergency restarts.
3. Take a pre-restart health snapshot (CPU, memory, active connections).
4. Execute restart following the service-specific runbook (see individual service runbooks in the Infra wiki).
5. Verify service health post-restart against baseline metrics before closing the maintenance window.

## 7. Standard Operating Procedure — Backup Verification

Backups are run nightly for all production databases and weekly for file servers. Backup verification runbook:

1. Confirm backup job completed successfully in the backup console (no failed job alerts).
2. Perform a random restore test on a non-production environment monthly.

3. Verify restored data integrity against a checksum of the source.
4. Log verification results in the Backup Compliance tracker.
5. Escalate any failed backup job as SEV-2 if it affects production databases.

## 8. Escalation Matrix

| Issue Type | First Responder | Escalation (30 min no resolution) | Final Escalation |
|---|---|---|---|
| Network outage | On-call Network Engineer | Infra Team Lead | Head of IT |
| Application down | On-call App Support | Engineering On-call | CTO |
| Security incident | Security On-call | Security Team Lead | CISO |
| Access/account issue | IT Helpdesk | IT Support Lead | Head of IT |

## 9. Offboarding Runbook

Upon receipt of an offboarding request from HR:

1. Disable all account access (email, VPN, SSO, internal tools) at the exact time specified by HR.
2. Revoke all active sessions and API tokens associated with the employee.
3. Retrieve and wipe Company-issued devices per the Asset Return process.
4. Archive employee’s email and files per the Data Retention Policy (typically 90 days before permanent deletion).
5. Update Asset Management system to reflect returned/decommissioned status.

## 10. On-Call Rotation

IT maintains a 24x7 on-call rotation across Network, Application Support, and Security functions, each on a weekly rotation published in the on-call calendar. On-call engineers are required to acknowledge SEV-1/SEV-2 pages within the response time targets in Section 2, escalating automatically if unacknowledged.

## 11. Change Management Process

All production changes (deployments, configuration changes, infrastructure updates) must be logged in the Change Management system with:

- Description of the change and rollback plan
- Risk assessment (Low/Medium/High)
- Scheduled window (avoiding business-critical periods)
- Approver sign-off (Team Lead for Low risk, Infra Head for Medium/High risk)

Emergency changes outside a scheduled window require verbal approval from the Infra Team Lead, followed by retroactive documentation within 24 hours.

## 12. Common Troubleshooting Runbooks

**Network Outage:** Check ISP status dashboard → verify core switch/router health → check for recent change log entries → escalate to ISP if confirmed external → notify affected floors/locations via facilities.

**Email Service Down:** Check mail server health dashboard → verify DNS/MX records unchanged → check recent security policy changes → escalate to email service provider if platform-side issue confirmed.

**Printer/Peripheral Issues:** Verify network connectivity to print server → check driver version against Software Catalog → re-queue stuck print jobs → escalate to

facilities vendor if hardware fault suspected.

## 13. Disaster Recovery Overview

The Company maintains a documented Disaster Recovery (DR) plan with a Recovery Time Objective (RTO) of 4 hours and Recovery Point Objective (RPO) of 1 hour for production systems. DR drills are conducted twice yearly, with results reviewed by the Infra Team and reported to the CTO.

## 14. Contact

For infrastructure escalations outside standard runbook coverage, contact the IT Infrastructure Team Lead via the on-call paging system.